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“INDIA SHOULD CONSIDER LAND POOLING MODEL”

Andhra Pradesh (AP) minister Nara Lokesh talks about what governments can learn from the state about overcoming the land availability challenge **BY SIDDHARTH ZARABI**

NARA LOKESH, Minister for Information Technology and HRD, AP, talks about, why investors are keen on Andhra Pradesh, and the how the government is tackling land challenge. Edited excerpts:



On driving investor interest in Andhra Pradesh.

First is talent and the quality of talent that we have in India nowhere in the world. The numbers that we have no country can compete with us.

It's interesting times where states are competing amongst each other to attract investments and it's no longer about ease of doing business, it's about speed of doing business. Third, the government's focus on Make in India.

Investors look for speed of doing business. I think if you look at the last seven months, the pace at which we've been able to close ground projects, no other state has been able to do that. And this is in seven months of the new government coming in. Imagine if you had three years, our pace would be very different.



On overcoming land availability challenges.

We have the land pooling model. Why can't we make the landowners part of the success



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story? Why can't they reap the benefits of all the development that's happening? Amravati was the exact concept of that. Because there's not even one acre of government land. Farmers came together, gave the land and they got developed land back and the government got some land, and the rest went for infrastructure.

This model can work. This is the way for India. It requires a little bit of political will. The cost of land continues to be a challenge for a country like India because of a sheer population. But with infrastructure, you can open pieces of land for development. **BT**

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